104. Al-Humazaa ~ The Backbiters

9 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

PSYCHOLOGICAL PROFILE OF ONE WHOSE GOD IS WEALTH AND THE CONSEQUENCES ON THE DAY OF QIYAMA

DID YOU KNOW?

HUMAZAA MEANS TO DESTROY ANOTHER'S CHARACTER AND INTEGRITY BY WORDS OR DEEDS THROUGH GOSSIP FOR PERSONAL GAIN - TO PRESENT ONESELF IN A BETTER LIGHT.

SELECTED AYAAT

104:1 Woe to every slandering backbiter.

104:2 Who amasses wealth and continually tallies it.

104:3 Assuming that his wealth will make him immortal.

104:4 No indeed! He will be thrown into the crushing fire (hutamaa).

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER TAKES ITS TITLE FROM THE CONDEMNATION OF EVERY SLANDERING BACKBITER IN THE FIRST VERSE.

IT IS A PERSONALITY TRAIT OF ONE WHO AMASSES WEALTH AND IS OVERLY CONCERNED WITH OTHERS; FINDING FLAWS OR MAKING THEM UP TO COVER HIS OWN WEAKNESSES AND INSECURITIES.

THE CHAPTER ENDS WITH THE PUNISHMENT THAT AWAITS THE ONE WHO DESTROYS ANOTHER CHARACTER AND INTEGRITY FOR PERSONAL GAIN.